

- » **If you see a Money Rule you like, adapt it for your situation.** You may not be able to afford a big wedding or paying in full for a house. Is that privileged? Yes! I share my rules so you can see exactly how I think about money and what matters to me, and if you like one, feel free to adapt it. When I first started learning about finances, I wished I could find out exactly how other people spent their money.
- » **Your rules will evolve over time.** Today, you might not be able to fly business class. But if that changes in the future, you can always tweak your rules. Looking at my own list, I can tell you that it certainly didn't start off like this. In my early twenties, my Rich Life was to be able to hop in a cab on a hot NYC day—we're talking about \$10 here! That's a perfect example of a Money Rule because it was meaningful to me. Pick rules that are meaningful to you today and know that you can—and will—change them over time.
- » **Money Rules should be straightforward enough to help you make key decisions about your money.** Let's take an example: You're visiting your family and deciding whether to fly home on Saturday or Sunday, but staying an extra day will cost \$150. How do you decide? You could weigh cost, time, or any number of factors. But if one of your Money Rules is "Relationships first," then the decision is obvious: You spend the \$150 to stay an extra day. (There are lots of options for making that \$150: You can find a less-important area to cut back on, you can earn more, or you can proactively save for situations like this—or all of those!) This is the beauty of Money Rules. They allow you to cut through the many situations you'll encounter and give you clear guidelines *that you created* to make your spending simpler and more meaningful.

I love this section because you're going to create the foundation of a Rich Life that's perfectly tailored to you. There's a reason that most personal finance advice is all the same: The world wants you to be vanilla. People will always push you to look and act the same as everyone else. It's up to you to push back.

As you fill in this next series of prompts, you'll start to see how you can get your money and time aligned with what's *really* important to you. And by the end of this section, you'll have your own list of Money Rules—a personal vision statement of money. Let's do it!